Topic 31 — Environmental Days

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

World Environment (पर्यावरण) Day (विश्व पर्यावरण दिवस) | World Wetlands Day (विश्व आर्द्रभूमि दिवस) | Earth Day (पृथ्वी दिवस) | International Day for Biological Diversity | International Day of Forests | World Water Day (विश्व जल दिवस) | World Ozone Day (विश्व ओजोन दिवस) | World Wildlife Day (विश्व वन्यजीव दिवस)

Sources baked in: UNEP; UN; Ramsar; CITES; CBD; Montreal Protocol; MoEFCC; UPPCS PYQs **Weight:** ★★★ High — date ↔ day matching; March cluster; World Wildlife Day trap **Last verified:** August 2026

Current Affairs (this topic)

- Annual themes for WED / Earth Day / IDF refresh; calendar dates stay fixed (WED = **5 June**).
- Do not invent UP-only international day dates.

31.1 World Environment Day

Identity: 5 June | UNEP | Stockholm 1972 (स्टॉकहोम सम्मेलन) | Host country rotates

- **World Environment Day (WED)** is the UN's main annual day for environmental awareness (पर्यावरण जागरूकता) and action.
- Date **5 June** marks the opening of the **Stockholm Conference on the Human Environment (1972)**; first observed in **1973**.
- Administered by **UNEP**; host country rotates and sets the year's theme.
- India hosted in **2011** ("Forests: Nature at Your Service") and **2018** ("Beat Plastic Pollution").
- Recent host/theme facts: **2019** China — Air Pollution; **2020** Colombia (+Germany) — Biodiversity; **2021** Pakistan — Ecosystem (पारिस्थितिकी तंत्र) Restoration; **2022** Only One Earth; **2023** Solutions to plastic pollution.
- **2022** also marked **50 years** since Stockholm 1972, which designated **5 June** as World Environment Day.
- WED is **not** Earth Day (**22 April**) and **not** Wetlands Day (**2 February**).

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q62

Which pair(s) NOT correctly matched? 1. International Ozone Day — 16 September 2. World Environment Day — 5 June 3. World Wildlife Day — 22 March

Options: A. 1 and 2 B. Only 3 C. 2 and 3 D. Only 1

Show answer

Ans: B — Pairs 1 and 2 are correct. Wildlife Day is **3 March**, not 22 March (that is Water Day).

> **Logic:** WED = **5 June** — Stockholm opening. Pair "WED — 2 February" is false.

31.2 World Wetlands Day

Identity: 2 February | Ramsar 1971 | Wise use

- **World Wetlands Day** marks adoption of the **Ramsar Convention on Wetlands** at Ramsar, Iran (**2 February 1971**).
- Focus is wetland conservation and **wise use** — sustainable human use, not a total ban.
- India has about **100** Ramsar sites; **Uttar Pradesh has 10**; **Tamil Nadu (नाडु)** leads with **16** (geography overlap).
- Date traps: **not 2 March**, **not 3 March** (Wildlife), **not 22 March** (Water).

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q147

World Wetlands Day is observed on—

Options: A. 10 January B. 15 January C. 1 February D. 2 February

Show answer

Ans: D

> **Logic:** Wetlands Day = **2 February only**.

31.3 Earth Day

Identity: 22 April | First 1970 (USA) | Civic global movement

- **Earth Day** promotes environmental protection, climate action, and sustainability every **22 April**.
- First observed **22 April 1970** in the **United States** (Senator Gaylord Nelson / mass teach-ins).
- Globally recognised civic movement — **not** the same UN treaty day as WED.
- Trap pairs: ≠ WED (**5 June**); ≠ Water Day (**22 March**); ≠ Biodiversity Day (**22 May**); ≠ **Earth Hour** (last Saturday of March, WWF — not on this syllabus).

> **Logic:** Earth Day = **22 April** — same “22” number as Water and Biodiversity, different months.

31.4 International Day for Biological Diversity

Identity: 22 May | CBD 1992 | Nairobi Final Act

- **International Day for Biological Diversity (IDB)** promotes biodiversity conservation awareness every **22 May**.
- Commemorates adoption of the **Convention on Biological Diversity** text at Nairobi (**22 May 1992**); Rio Earth Summit signed CBD the same year.
- Originally linked to **29 December** (CBD entry into force 1993); shifted to **22 May** from **2000** — papers use **22 May** only.
- The UN declared **2011–2020** the **United Nations Decade on Biodiversity**.
- India implements CBD through the **Biological Diversity Act 2002** (जैव विविधता अधिनियम 2002) (NBA / SBBs / BMCs).
- Scope is broader than World Wildlife Day (**3 March**, CITES fauna focus).

> **Logic:** IDB = **22 May** — not 22 March (Water) and not 5 June (WED). Decade 2011–20 ≠ climate-decade branding.

31.5 International Day of Forests

Identity: 21 March | UNGA 2012 | Between Wildlife and Water

- **International Day of Forests** raises awareness of forests and sustainable forest management every **21 March**.
- It was proclaimed by the **UN General Assembly in 2012**.
- India's **Wildlife Week** is celebrated **2–8 October** (national awareness week — not the same as World Wildlife Day).
- Theme examples: IDF 2018 = Forests and Sustainable Cities; IDF 2024 = Forests and innovation.
- Proclaimed by the **UN General Assembly in 2012**.
- Sits in the March ladder between **Wildlife (3 Mar)** and **Water (22 Mar)** — easy to drop in match lists.
- India observance links to ISFR messaging and plantation drives (Van Mahotsav is a separate July campaign).

> **Logic:** Forests = **21 March** — not 22 March (Water) and not 3 March (Wildlife).

31.6 World Water Day

Identity: 22 March | UN 1993 | Freshwater focus

- **World Water Day** focuses on freshwater resources, access, and sustainable water management every **22 March**.

- Designated by the **United Nations** (observed from **1993**); coordinated under **UN-Water** (programme continuity from **2003**).
- Theme **2024**: *Leveraging Water for Peace* (also phrased as prosperity and peace in some bank notes).
- Most dangerous trap: confuse with **World Wildlife Day (3 March)** — used this exact false pair.
- Also ≠ Wetlands Day (**2 February**) and ≠ Earth Day (**22 April**).

> **Logic:** Water = **22 March**. Wildlife = **3 March**. Never swap.

31.7 World Ozone Day

Identity: 16 September | Montreal Protocol 1987 | UNEP Ozone Secretariat

- **World Ozone Day** (International Day for the Preservation of the Ozone Layer) is observed every **16 September**.
- Marks signing of the **Montreal Protocol on Substances that Deplete the Ozone Layer (16 September 1987)**; Montreal entered into force on **1 January 1989**.
- The UN General Assembly declared the day in **1994**.
- Linked to the Vienna Convention family; administered with UNEP Ozone Secretariat support.
- India observance often highlights HCFC phase-out and cooling-sector compliance.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q82

On which date is Ozone Day observed?

Options: A. October 2 B. September 16 C. April 29 D. January 30

Show answer

Ans: B

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q114

'World Ozone Day' is celebrated on

Options: A. 25 December B. 21 April C. 16 September D. 30 January

Show answer

Ans: C

> **Logic:** Ozone Day = **16 September** — Montreal Protocol date. Do not swap it with World Wildlife Day (**3 March**).

31.8 World Wildlife Day

Identity: 3 March | CITES 1973 | UN + CITES

- **World Wildlife Day** celebrates wild fauna and flora and fights wildlife crime every **3 March**.
- Date marks adoption of **CITES** (**Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species**) on **3 March 1973**.
- UN proclaimed the day in **2013**; observance involves UN and CITES Secretariat.
- **Highest-yield trap:** listing Wildlife Day as **22 March** (that is Water Day) — wrong pair in **

> **Logic:** Wildlife = **3 March only**. Water = **22 March**. Wildlife Week in India = **2–8 October**. **International Tiger Day = 29 July** (St Petersburg Summit **2010**).

31.9 International Tiger Day

Identity: 29 July | St Petersburg 2010 | Awareness day

- **International Tiger Day** is observed every **29 July**.
- It was founded at the **Saint Petersburg Tiger Summit (2010)** to raise awareness for tiger conservation.
- Do not confuse with World Wildlife Day (**3 March**) or Wildlife Week (**2–8 October**).